STAKEHOLDER REPORT · EDUVOS CHALLENGE ENTRY

# VOSSIE

## Your campus, open for business.

The student marketplace for every Eduvos campus. This report covers what the app does, how it's built, how far the build has come and what's left before launch.


**PREPARED FOR**
The Vossie team

**DESIGNER AND DEVELOPER**
Lama Nkuna


**STATUS AS OF**
21 October 2026

# 01 AT A GLANCE

Vossie lets Eduvos students buy, sell, swap and ask for things on their own campus. They deal with shops that the Incubation Hub has checked, and hand items over at approved campus pickup points.

**13 / 13**
planned build stages done (A to M)

**63**
pages, plus 10 server endpoints

**2,701**
unit tests passing on main

**2,463**
database security tests (Supabase branch)

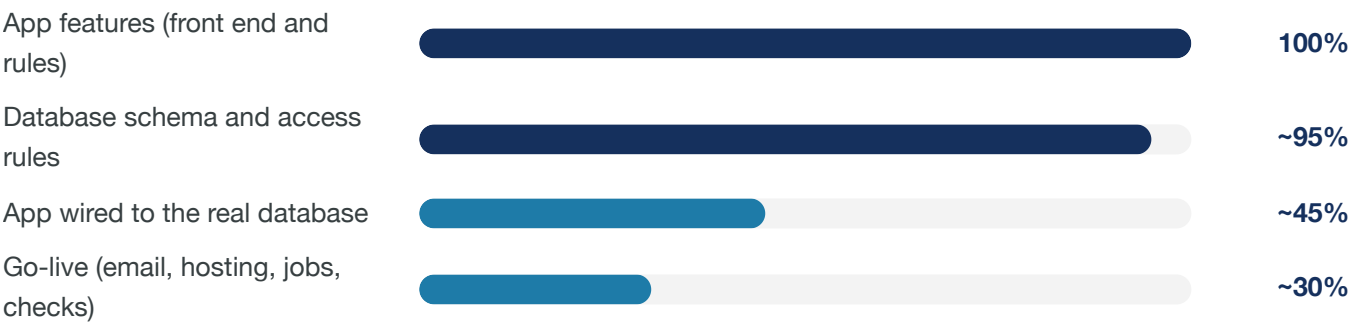
**13**
campuses: 12 Eduvos campuses plus Eduvos Online

**10**
shopping categories

**≈150 KB**
JavaScript on a first visit (compressed), on budget

**81**
product decisions logged

## Where the build stands




The percentages are estimates from the build plans: wiring counts the backend tasks done against those planned, and go-live counts the items ticked on the go-live checklist.

**The one thing to understand**
Every feature is built and tested in **sample mode**. In sample mode the app runs on realistic sample shops, listings, requests and Hub posts held in the server's memory, and a restart resets them. Sign-in codes appear on screen instead of being emailed. The real backend (Supabase) is being connected behind the same screens one area at a time, so **nothing a student sees has to change** when it switches over.

## Live preview

A team preview runs on Vercel at **vossie-pi.vercel.app**, in sample mode and hidden from search engines. To try it, sign in with one of the sample accounts on page 4.

# 02 WHAT VOSSIE IS

"Buy, sell and swap with students on your Eduvos campus, from shops the Incubation Hub has checked."

## Why it beats a WhatsApp group or Facebook Marketplace

### Checked shops

- The Incubation Hub approves every shop before it can list.
- "Verified" is an extra badge that only the Hub can give.

### Safe handovers

- Items change hands at approved pickup points on each campus.
- Buyers see the item before they pay.
- There are no couriers and no payments in the app.

### Private messaging

- Conversations stay inside Vossie, so nobody shares a phone number or email.
- A scam check warns the sender about deposits, bank details, couriers and codes.

### Backed by the Hub

- Sellers get mentors, office hours, events and tips from the Incubation Hub.
- Vossie is a way into student entrepreneurship, not just a classifieds board.

## Who it's for

| Person | What they come for |
|---|---|
| **Visitor** | Browses every campus, reads listings, shops, Looking For and the Hub. No account needed. |
| **Student (buyer)** | Saves items, follows shops, messages sellers, posts Looking For requests, saves searches, RSVPs to Hub events. |
| **Seller** | Applies to open a shop, lists items with photos, answers enquiries, offers help on requests, watches their numbers and badge. |
| **Mentor** | Follows the shops assigned to them, keeps private notes, writes Hub posts and runs office hours. |
| **Admin** | Approves and verifies shops, handles reports, picks Featured sellers, manages pickup points and staff roles, reads anonymised numbers. |

## Voice and positioning

- **Brand line:** "Your campus, open for business." (decision 71; the positioning and editorial spec is a draft waiting for Lama's review)
- **Words we use:** students, shop, campus, pickup point, swap.
- **Words we avoid:** platform, users, vendors, empower. No exclamation marks.
- **The test for anything new beyond buying and selling.** It must do at least one of these:
  - lead a student to something to buy or ask for;
  - help a seller sell;
  - make a handover safer.

# 03 TRYING IT YOURSELF

On the sign-in page, sample mode shows a button for each sample account, so there's no code to type. Each account shows a different side of the app.

| Account | Email | Role | Try this |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Thandi** | student@eduvos.com | Student, Midrand | Save items, message a seller, post a Looking For request, save a search |
| **Sipho** | seller@eduvos.com | Approved seller, owns "Tech corner" | Dashboard, list an item with photos, reply to enquiries, offer on a request |
| **Lerato** | pending@eduvos.com | Seller waiting for approval ("Crochet corner") | See the waiting state, prepare draft listings |
| **Naledi** | mentor@eduvos.com | Mentor of Tech corner | Mentor dashboard, notes, CSV export, Hub posts, office hours |
| **Pieter** | admin@eduvos.com | Admin | Approve Lerato's shop, handle reports, Featured, staff roles, numbers |

## The sample data

**29**
sample shops, 9 of them Verified

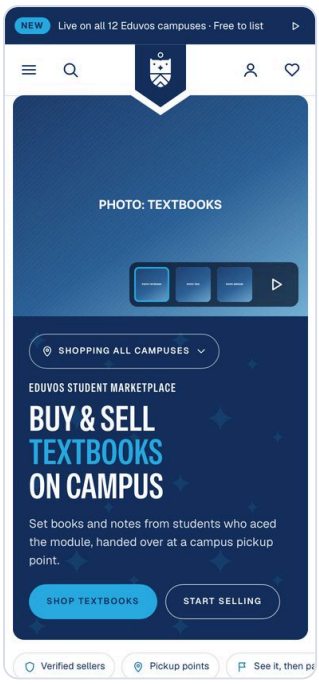
**16**
Looking For requests (14 open)

**18**
Hub posts: 8 events, 4 office hours, 6 tips

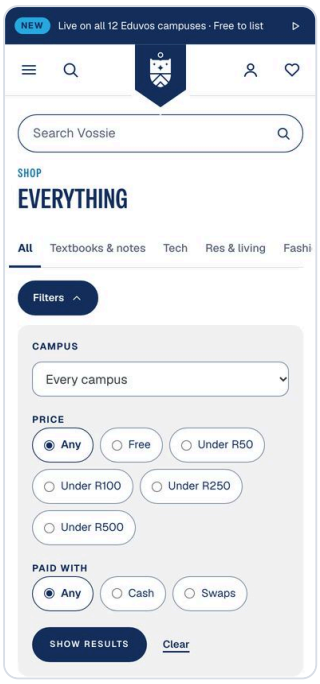
**24**
sample pickup points

> **Remember:** anything you create on the preview disappears when the server restarts. That's by design, so the preview never holds real personal data.

## Key screens (phone, 390px wide)



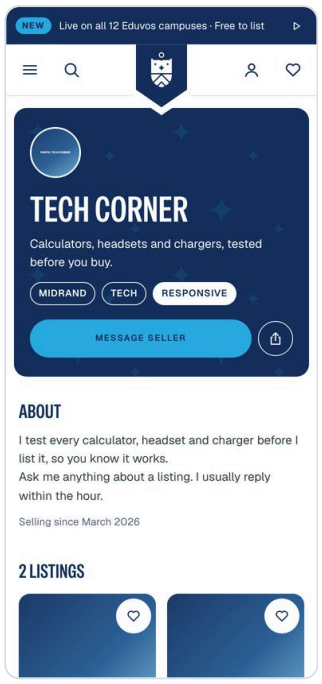

Homepage



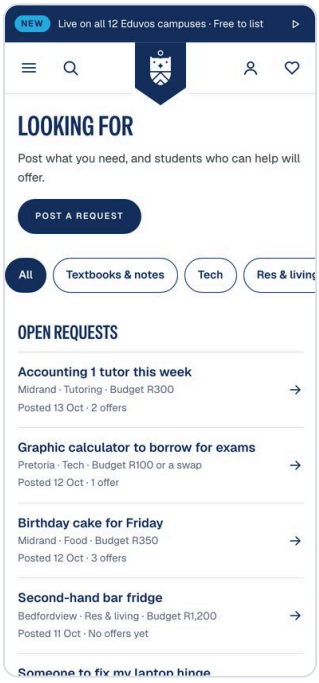

Browse and filters



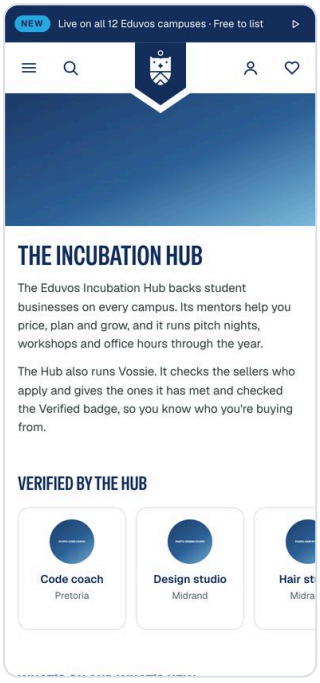

Listing



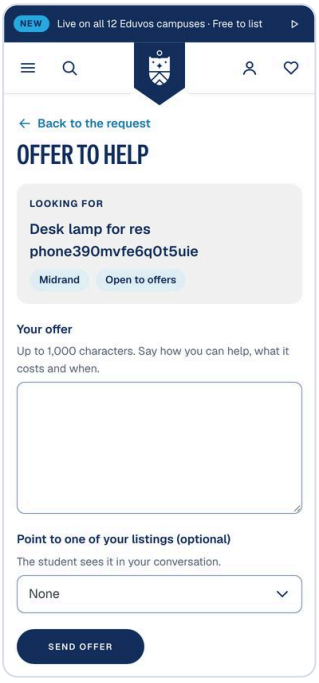

Shop storefront



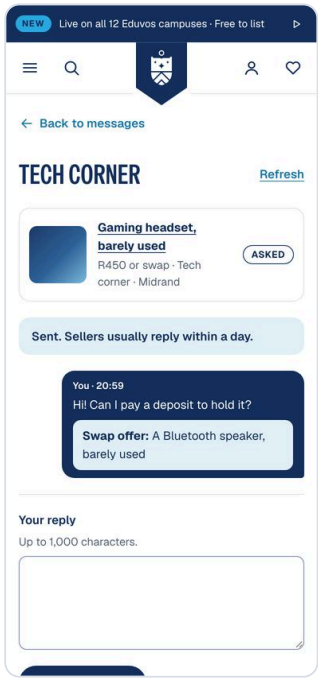

Looking For board



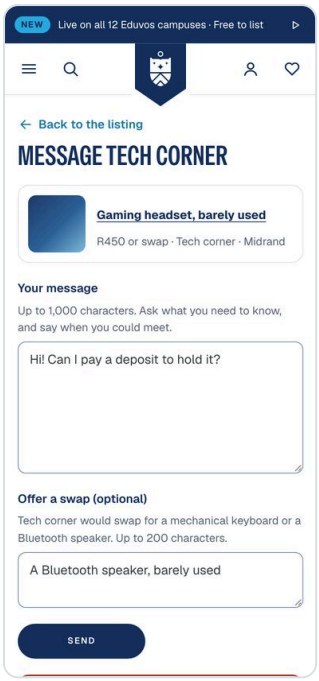

The Incubation Hub



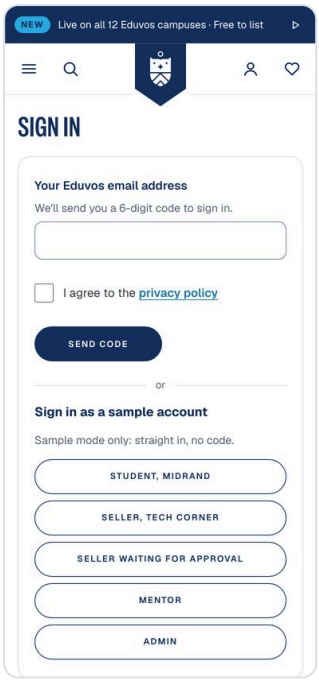

Offer to help



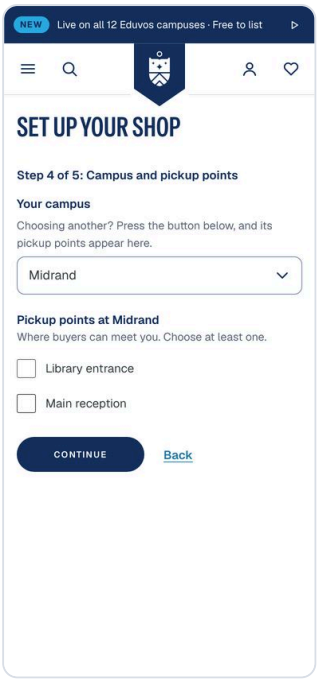

Message thread



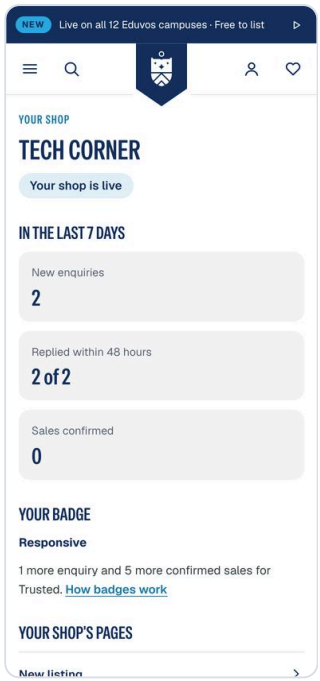

Message a seller



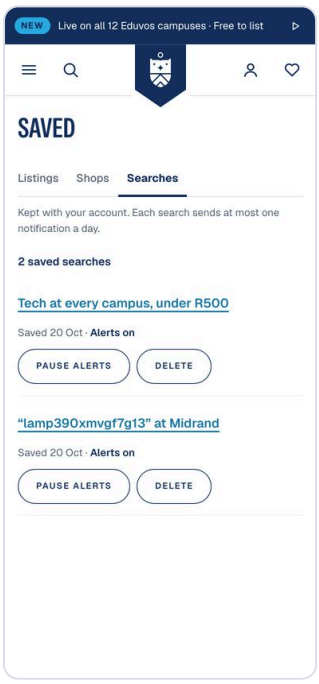

Sign in



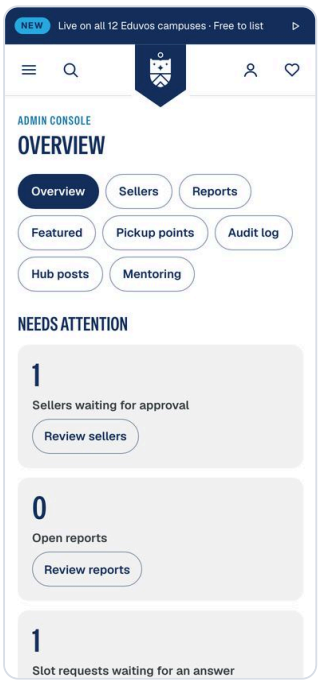

Shop set-up



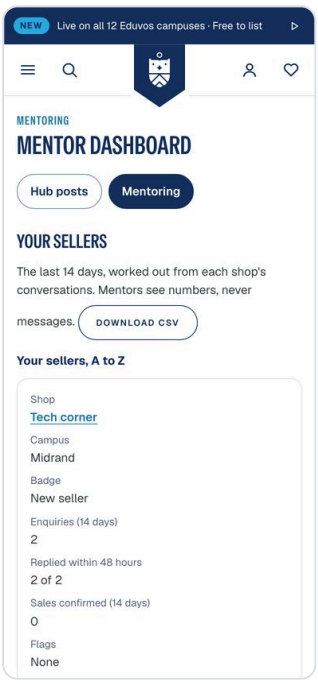

Seller dashboard



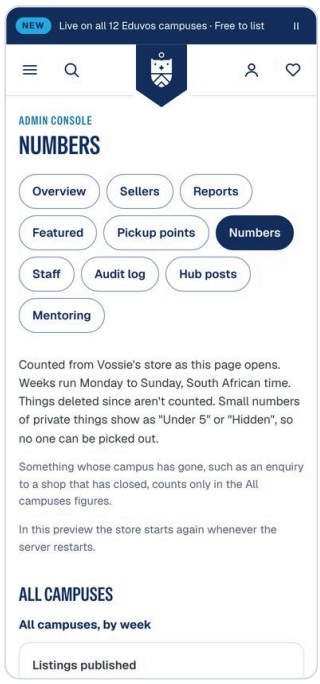

Saved searches




Admin overview




Mentor dashboard




Admin numbers

These screenshots come from the review at the end of each stage. Since then the phone layout has gained a bottom tab bar, and the photos are placeholders until real ones are added.

# 04 EVERY FEATURE

Everything below is built and covered by automated tests in sample mode.

## SHOPPING

### Homepage

Everyone · /

- A hero slider, then categories with budget shortcuts: Under R50, R100, R250, Free and Swaps.
- Shop by campus, Just listed, Featured today, Looking For, Free and swaps, and What's on.
- Returning visitors see "Pick up where you left off".
- Signed-in students see new messages and sales to confirm.

### Campus choice

Everyone · header and menu

- Pick your campus once, and it comes first everywhere.
- "All campuses" is always one tap away.
- A listing says where it's collected, with a note when that isn't your campus.

### Browse, search and filters

Buyers · /browse

- Search finds a word despite one typo, and matches seller names too.
- 10 category tabs, plus filters for campus, price (Free included) and how you pay, and sorting.
- The page address holds the whole search, so it can be shared or bookmarked.
- Works on slow phones before the app's code has loaded.

### Listing page

Buyers · /listings/[id]

- Photos, price, swap terms, where to collect it, the seller, and a safety note.
- Message seller, Save and Report sit in a dock on phones.
- Sold and paused listings are labelled, and WhatsApp share previews are built in.

### Shop storefronts

Buyers · /sellers/[slug]

- A poster band shows the shop's campus, category, Verified status and trust badge.
- Message, share, follow or report the shop.
- About, "Selling since", and every listing.

### Saved, follows and collections

Buyers · /saved, /collections/[slug]

- Heart any listing to save it. Saved has tabs for items, shops and searches.
- Follow shops for at most one new-listing alert a day. A shop sees its follower count, never who follows.
- Hub-curated collections fill themselves from every campus.

### Saved-search alerts

Buyers · Save this search on /browse

- Save up to 20 searches, and pause, resume or delete each one.
- One in-app alert per search per day when a new listing matches.

### Recent activity

Everyone · search overlay, homepage

- Recent searches, trending searches on your campus, and category shortcuts.
- Up to 6 recently viewed items, kept on your own device only.

## COMMUNITY

### Looking For

Students ask, approved shops offer · /looking-for

- Post what you need, with a budget and an optional needed-by date. The request doesn't name you.
- Each request shows up to 4 matching listings already on Vossie.
- Approved shops offer to help through a message thread, and you're told about each offer.
- Edit, close, reopen or delete your requests. Requests close themselves, with a reminder 2 days before.

### The Incubation Hub

Everyone reads; staff write · /hub

- One feed of events, office hours and tips, plus the Verified sellers.
- Students RSVP to events and request office-hours slots.
- Mentors and admins write posts, with drafts, cover photos and a preview.

## ACCOUNTS, MESSAGING AND SAFETY

### Sign-in

Students · /login

- Your student email and a 6-digit code: it lasts 10 minutes, with 5 tries and up to 5 codes an hour.
- Only allowed email domains get in (eduvos.com and vossie.net).
- On a first sign-in you give a first name and your campus. Sessions last 30 days.

### Account and privacy

Students · /account, /account/privacy

- Edit your details and see your consent record.
- Download all your data as one file.
- Delete your account: everything goes at once and you're signed out.

### Messaging

Buyers and sellers · /messages

- Message a seller about a listing, with an optional swap offer, or ask a shop a question.
- Buying and Selling inbox tabs. Each thread shows Asked, Replied, Done or Confirmed.
- The seller marks a sale done and the buyer confirms it. A sale confirms itself after 7 days.
- A scam-words check runs before sending. Emails and phone numbers are never shown.

### Reports, safety and notifications

Students · /report, /safety, /trust, /notifications

- Report a listing, shop or request: 7 reasons, up to 10 reports a day. You're told the outcome.
- The Safety and Trust pages explain Verified, the badges, Featured and what happens after a report.
- Notifications cover messages, offers, alerts, approvals and reminders, with a red count on the account icon.

## SELLING

### Opening a shop

Sellers · /sell, /sell/onboarding

- A "Sell on Vossie" pitch, then 5 steps: basics, about, photo, campus and pickup points, review.
- Send for approval. While waiting, you can prepare draft listings.
- A declined seller sees the reason and can apply again.

### Listings and photos

Sellers · /sell/listings

- Tabs for Available, Paused, Sold and Drafts. Pause, resume, mark sold, relist or delete.
- Up to 6 photos of up to 5 MB each. They're shrunk on the phone, with location data removed.
- Reorder photos and pick the cover.

### Seller dashboard

Sellers · /sell

- Whether the shop is live, and the last 7 days' enquiries, replies within 48 hours and confirmed sales.
- Your trust badge (New seller, Responsive or Trusted) and what the next one needs.
- Your follower count, and a Pause my shop button.

### Shop profile

Sellers · /sell/profile

- Edit the name, tagline, photo, about text, campus and pickup points.
- The shop's link can be changed once. Old links keep working.

## STAFF TOOLS

### Mentors

Mentors · /mentor

- Your assigned shops, with 14-day numbers and warning flags.
- Private notes and check-ins, exported as a spreadsheet (CSV).
- Write Hub posts and work through the office-hours queue.

### Shop review and reports

Admins · /admin/sellers, /admin/reports

- Approve, decline (with a reason), verify, pause or resume a shop, and assign its mentor.
- Reports: dismiss, hide the listing or request, or pause the shop.
- Hidden items come back only through "Show again".

### Featured and pickup points

Admins · /admin/featured, /admin/pickup-points

- A daily row of 4 Featured shops per campus, with pins. Shops featured longest ago come back first.
- Add, rename, retire and reuse pickup points.

### Staff roles, numbers and audit log

Admins · /admin/staff, /admin/numbers, /admin/audit

- Give a mentor or admin role by exact email only. The last admin can't be removed.
- Weekly numbers per campus. Counts of 1 to 4 are hidden so nobody can be identified.
- Every staff action goes into an audit log that can't be edited.

## BUILT INTO EVERY PAGE

### Phone-first app feel

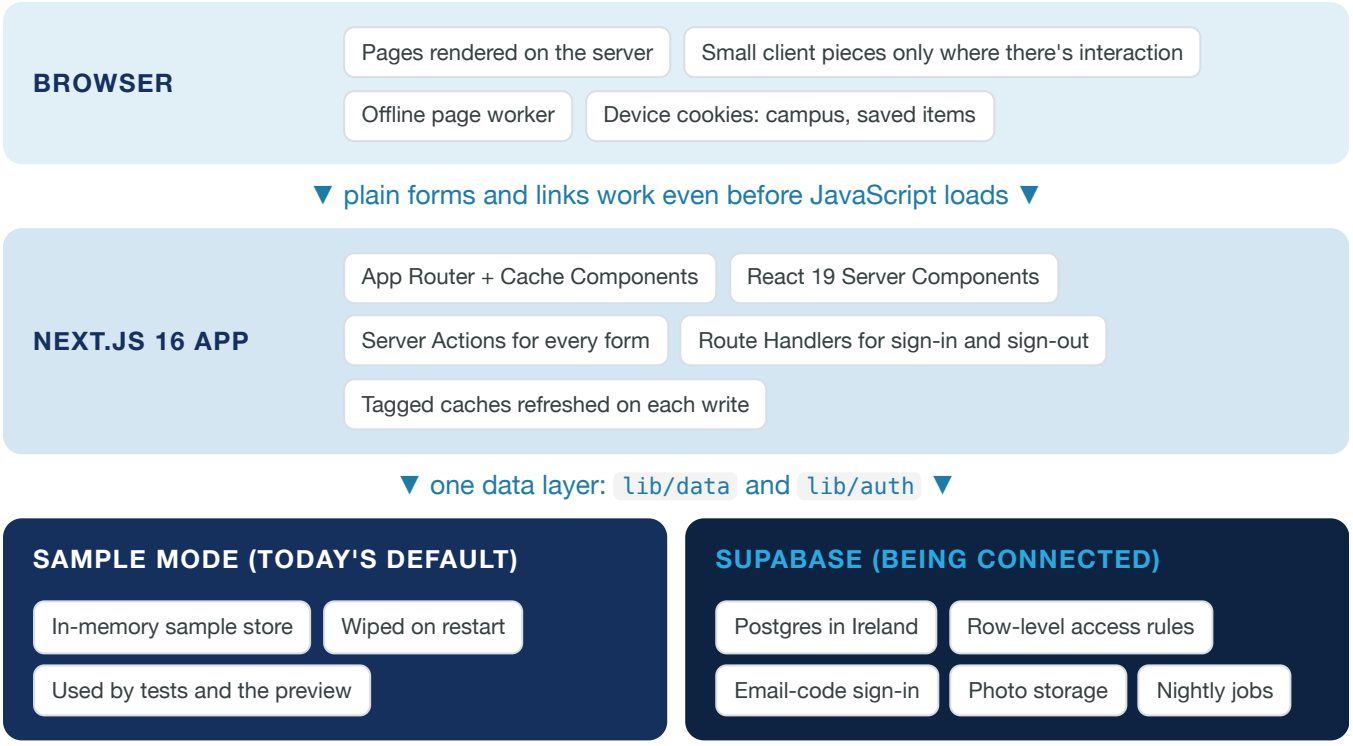
- A bottom tab bar on phones: Home, Shop, Sell, Saved and Account.
- The header hides as you scroll.
- Add to home screen (installable). An offline page appears when the network drops.
- Data saver skips photos below the first screen and turns off motion.

### Accessible and fast

- Targets WCAG 2.2 AA. Automated checks find no serious issues, and every tap target is at least 44px.
- About 150 KB of JavaScript on a first visit, built for cheap phones on mobile data.
- Tested at screen widths from 360 to 1440px.

# 05 HOW IT'S BUILT

Vossie is one web app. It works in any phone or desktop browser and can be installed to a phone's home screen. Almost all of the work happens on the server, so phones download as little as possible.




A single setting ( `VOSSIE_BACKEND=supabase` ) moves the app from the sample store to Supabase. Both sides share the same function signatures and are checked by the same contract tests.

## The stack

| Part | Choice |
|---|---|
| Framework | Next.js 16.4 (App Router, Cache Components), React 19.3, TypeScript |
| Styling | Tailwind CSS 4.3, the Eduvos colours (navy #15305D and sky #29ABE2), and a star texture |
| Database and sign-in | Supabase: Postgres 17, Auth email codes, Storage. Hosted in Ireland, because Supabase has no African region |
| Hosting | Vercel, with functions pinned to Dublin next to the database. Private GitHub repository |
| Email | Resend, sending sign-in codes from wemakesites.co.za for the submission |
| Testing | Vitest and Testing Library (unit tests), Playwright and axe (end to end and accessibility), pgTAP (database rules) |
| Package manager | pnpm 10 |

## Design principles the code follows

- **Server first.** Pages are Server Components. Client code is added only where a person interacts, which keeps phones fast on mobile data.

- **Supabase only on the server.** The browser never talks to the database. The keys stay secret, and sign-in cookies can't be read by page scripts.
- **Every write refreshes the right cache.** Listings, sellers, requests and the Hub each have a cache tag that is cleared when their data changes.
- **Forms that work without JavaScript.** Every form is a plain HTML form posted to the server. Errors are kept on the server, never in the page address.
- **South African time.** Times are stored in UTC and shown in Johannesburg time, never the server's own clock.
- **Rules held twice.** Each rule (the own-shop rule, the limits, the privacy rules) is checked in the app and again in the database, in the same transaction as the write.

## Quality and testing

**315**
unit test files (2,701 tests)

**41**
end-to-end test files run on phone, tablet and desktop sizes

**2,463**
database tests of access rules and functions

**440**
source files, about 36,000 lines

- **Reviewed in stages.** Each stage starts from a written design spec and a step-by-step plan. A reviewer checks the plan before the build and the code after it.
- **Accessibility.** Every page is scanned with axe at phone and desktop sizes. Contrast rules are written into the brand guide; for example, sky blue never carries small text on white.
- **Performance.** A test fails the build if a page's first-visit JavaScript goes past its stop line. Layout shift stays under 0.05.
- **Security.** Sign-in codes and session tokens are stored only as keyed hashes (HMAC-SHA-256), and every guess is counted. Security headers are on. Sign-out and account deletion end with a full page reload, so a shared computer keeps no signed-in pages.

## Privacy by design (POPIA)

### Collect the minimum

- Looking For requests read "Asked by a student at {campus}".
- No phone numbers or emails are exchanged.
- Location data is stripped from photos, both in the browser and on the server.

### Students stay in control

- Consent is recorded with the policy version.
- A one-file data download.
- One-step account deletion that removes requests, follows, saved searches and the shop's followers.

### Staff see only what they need

- Mentors' notes are never shown to the seller.
- Small counts are hidden in the numbers.
- Roles are given by exact email only, never from a list of students.

### Every cookie named

- Every cookie and storage key starts with `vossie_`.
- A test fails if the privacy page doesn't name one.

# 06 PROGRESS SO FAR

The build ran in stages. Each stage was designed, planned, reviewed, built test-first and checked end to end before the next one began.

**8 OCT**
### Homepage design spec
The brand, layout, accessibility and performance budget agreed

**12 OCT**
### Foundation, site shell and homepage
Header, menu, search overlay, campus picker, footer, and every homepage section

**13 OCT**
### Browse and listing pages
Search, filters, sorting, listing detail and share cards

**14 OCT**
### Shopping, info and community pages
Storefronts, Saved, collections, legal and safety pages, Looking For, the Hub

**14 OCT**
### Stages D and E: accounts and messaging
Email-code sign-in, privacy settings, messaging, reports, notifications

**15 OCT**
### Stage F: selling
Shop onboarding, listing form, photos, dashboard

**15 OCT**
### Supabase phase A
Database foundation and the "Vossie Market" project

**19 OCT**
### Stages G and H: staff tools and community actions
Admin console, mentors, Hub posting, requests, offers, follows, offline page

**20 OCT**
### Phone tab bar and a hiding header
An app-like layout on phones

**20 OCT**
### Stages I, J and K
Saved-search alerts; staff roles, numbers and Show again; hardening (message limits, keyed hashes, full-reload sign-out)

**20 OCT**
### Schema catch-up
12 migrations that bring the database up to stages G to J

**21 OCT**
### Stages L and M: housekeeping and follow-ups
The own-shop rule, requests closing themselves, reminders, fairer Featured

**21 OCT**
### Backend: step 2b, C0, C1 and phase B
The schema for stages L and M, the backend switch, public pages on Supabase, sign-in on Supabase

**21 OCT**
### Backend: C2/C3 started
The SQL for selling, photos and messaging (tasks 0 to 4 of 18)

Navy dots are app stages, merged into `main`. Sky dots are backend work on the `backend/phases-b-c` branch.

## Status by area

| Area | App (sample) | Database | Wired to Supabase |
|---|---|---|---|
| Public pages: catalogue, shops, Hub, requests, Featured | Done | Done | Done (C1) |
| Sign-in, sessions, account deletion | Done | Done | Done (phase B) |
| Selling and photos | Done | Done | In progress |
| Messaging, reports, notifications | Done | Done | In progress |
| Looking For, offers, follows | Done | Done | Planned (C4) |
| Saved-search alerts | Done | Done | Planned (C4) |
| Staff tools, roles, numbers, audit | Done | Done | Planned (C5) |
| Nightly jobs (request closing, reminders) | Done | Done | At go-live |

## The backend, phase by phase

| Phase | What it covers | Status |
|---|---|---|
| **A · Foundation** | The Supabase project, the first 8 migrations, access rules, the seed and the Supabase project "Vossie Market" | Merged |
| **Schema catch-up** | 12 migrations for staff tools, the Hub, requests, follows, saved searches and complete account deletion | Merged |
| **Step 2b** | Campuses, categories and pickup points as migrations; the allowed email domains; requests closing in the database; read-only public views | Done |
| **C0 · The switch** | `VOSSIE_BACKEND`, server-only clients, and contract tests that run the same scenarios against both backends | Done |
| **C1 · Public reads** | Pickup points, the catalogue, Hub posts, requests, Featured, shop stats and badges | Done |
| **B · Sign-in** | Supabase Auth email codes, 30-day sliding sessions, the `vossie_auth` cookie, sign-in tested end to end on local Supabase | Done |
| **C2/C3 · Selling, photos, messaging** | 18 tasks. The SQL and shared pieces (tasks 0 to 4) are done | 5 of 18 |
| **C4/C5 · Community, alerts, staff** | 24 tasks, ending in the full end-to-end run on local Supabase | Planned |
| **Going live** | Migrations pushed to "Vossie Market" (the live project), email switched on, go-live on vossie-pi.vercel.app | To do |

Phases B, C0 to C3 and step 2b are on the `backend/phases-b-c` branch and are merged into `main` only with Lama's go-ahead. The branch has 35 migrations, 2,463 database tests and 2,948 unit tests.

# 07 PRODUCT RULES WORTH KNOWING

These decisions shape how Vossie behaves. All 81 are in the decisions log (`docs/reference/LANDING-DECISIONS.md`).

| Rule | What it means |
|---|---|
| **Approval before selling** | The Hub approves a shop before its listings go public. Verified is a separate badge on top. |
| **Messages stay in Vossie** | There's no WhatsApp handoff (decision 57). Messages are plain text, links aren't made clickable, and there's a scam-words check. |
| **Message limits** | 40 new conversations in 24 hours and 120 messages an hour per account. The numbers can be raised. |
| **Anonymous requests** | A Looking For request never names the asker. Only approved shops can offer: one offer per request, and 20 offers a day. |
| **Request limits** | 5 open requests at a time and 5 new ones a day per student. |
| **Requests close themselves** | 3 days after the needed-by date, or else 30 days after the last change. The asker gets one reminder 2 days before. |
| **The own-shop rule** | No admin decides about their own shop, its listings or their own request. Nobody removes the mentor of their own shop. |
| **Staff roles** | Roles are given by exact email only. Admins can't remove their own admin role, and the last admin can't be removed. |
| **Hidden stays hidden** | Hidden content comes back only through Show again, which is logged and tells the seller. Hiding it again needs a new report. |
| **Featured is fair** | 4 places per campus each day, the campus's own shops first. Shops featured longest ago come back first. |
| **Reports** | Up to 10 reports a day, one open report per item, and the person who reported is told the outcome. |
| **Badges** | New seller, then Responsive, then Trusted, earned from replies and confirmed sales. There are no view counts. |

# 08 WHAT'S LEFT

The product is complete. The work left is making it run on real data and getting it live.

## 1 · Finish connecting the real backend

- [ ] **C2/C3, tasks 5 to 17:** selling, photos and messaging read and write through Supabase.
- [ ] **C4/C5, 24 tasks:** Looking For, offers, follows, saved-search alerts and every staff tool on Supabase.
- [ ] **Step 5:** the full end-to-end suite on the local Supabase stack.
- [ ] **Merge into main:** merge `backend/phases-b-c` into `main`, with Lama's go-ahead.

## 2 · Going live

- [ ] **Supabase access:** renew the Supabase CLI token for "Vossie Market". The current one expires on 22 October.
- [ ] **Migrations:** dry-run all 35 migrations, then push them to "Vossie Market", which serves as the live database.
- [ ] **Email:** Resend sends the sign-in codes, and the sign-in page stops showing them.
- [ ] **Environment settings:** the HMAC key, the site address, and a stable Server Actions key.
- [ ] **Photos:** upload straight to Supabase Storage, with a quota per account.
- [ ] **Nightly jobs:** closing requests, reminders, trust badges and the 7-day sale confirmation.
- [ ] **Operations:** error monitoring, backups and a Content Security Policy.
- [ ] **Search engines:** unset `VOSSIE_NOINDEX` on the live site.

## 3 · Checks before launch

- [ ] **Device suite:** rerun the full device suite, which last ran fully before stage M.
- [ ] **Stale pages:** on a long-running server, a few write tests saw a stale page after a write. Check the cache under load on the real backend.
- [ ] **Real phones:** test on a cheap Android phone, check the back button after sign-out on iOS Safari, and try the offline worker's kill switch.
- [ ] **Real photos:** measure load speed (LCP) again once real photos are in.
- [ ] **Screen readers:** a manual check, alongside the automated scans.

## 4 · Decisions for the team

- [ ] **Open review points:** about 18 from stages L and M, most of them confirmations (closing and reminder timing, Featured's order, sample wording).
- [ ] **Positioning spec:** review it. Phase 1 (the wording) can be built right away, and phase 2 (Stories in the Hub) is ready to plan.
- [ ] **Retention:** how long messages, reports and notifications are kept, written into the privacy policy.
- [ ] **Email notifications:** whether new messages or alerts also send an email. Today they're in-app only.
- [ ] **Launch content:** enough real shops listed before day one, and whether to start with one campus as a pilot.

## After launch

Delivery between campuses, email digests for saved searches, price-drop alerts and live message updates.

# 09 NOTES FOR THE TEAM

## Where to find things

| Document | What it holds |
|---|---|
| `docs/PROGRESS.md` | The build log, updated at the end of every session |
| `docs/reference/LANDING-DECISIONS.md` | Every product decision, with the reason |
| `docs/reference/GO-LIVE.md` | The go-live checklist |
| `docs/superpowers/specs/` | The design spec for each stage |
| `docs/superpowers/plans/` | The step-by-step build plan for each stage |
| `docs/progress/` | Review screenshots for each stage, at phone and desktop sizes |
| `CLAUDE.md` | The project's code rules, brand rules and privacy rules |

## Running it locally

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| `pnpm dev --port 3100` | Starts the app in sample mode |
| `pnpm test` | Runs the unit tests |
| `pnpm e2e` | Runs the end-to-end tests. Restart the server between full runs, because the sample store lives in memory |
| `pnpm lint` · `pnpm typecheck` · `pnpm build` | Code checks and the production build |

Use pnpm only, never npm or yarn. The Next.js version has breaking changes from older versions: read the docs bundled in `node_modules/next/dist/docs/` before using a Next.js API.

## Rules that keep the project healthy

- **Git safety first.** Check `git status` before any git action. Commits and pushes need Lama's go-ahead. Never run destructive git commands without confirming each time.
- **Brand.** Use only the colour tokens and the three font roles. Sky never carries small text on white, links use sky-dark, and icons come only from `components/icons.tsx`, never emoji.
- **Speed budget.** A link that prefetches a page with client code costs bytes on every page, so links don't prefetch unless there's a reason. Keep each page near 150 KB.
- **Layouts.** Use the custom `wide:` and `desk:` breakpoints (never `md:` or `lg:`), 44px touch targets, no hover-only features, and only transform and opacity in animations.
- **Privacy.** Name every new cookie on the privacy page; a test enforces this. Never put personal data in a page address.
- **Data.** Only `lib/data` touches the store. Every write clears its cache tag, and new tables get access rules and pgTAP tests.